

Palestine

Free ways to help, and the context behind them.

Where things stand. A ceasefire has held in part since 10 October 2025. Gaza's health ministry, which operates under the de facto authorities, reports 1,334 people killed since then, to 2 September 2026. Most of Gaza's 2.1 million people are approaching the rainy season in overcrowded displacement sites, and settler violence in the West Bank remains high, according to the [UN \(OCHA, 4 September 2026\)](#).

Checked 21 September 2026. Every link goes to its own source.

Displaced ~1,900,000 · 9 in 10 people in Gaza

LISTEN

Start with the music.

Streams and album sales pay artists directly. These are starting points, not a canon.

Mohammed Assaf (<https://www.wxtj.fm/wxtj-writes-by-isabel-xiao-5-palestinian-artists-to-support/>)

From Gaza; won the second season of Arab Idol. Patriotic hymns and classic Arabic love songs.

DAM and Shadia Mansour (<https://scenenoise.com/Features/Palestinian-Resistance-Music-Then-Now>)

DAM has made Palestinian hip-hop since 1999; Shadia Mansour is one of its best-known voices.

Bashar Murad (<https://www.visionary-mag.com/post/9-palestinian-music-artists-you-need-to-check-out-before-the-end-of-the-year>)

Singer-songwriter and video artist in East Jerusalem. His debut EP Maskhara came out in 2021.

Kamilya Jubran (<https://www.nateholdermusic.com/post/10-palestinian-musicians-to-learn-about>)

Oud and qanun player and vocalist, formerly the lead singer of Sabreen. Artistic director of the nonprofit Zamkana.

Saint Levant (<https://saintlevant.com/>)

Born in Jerusalem in 2000. Multilingual pop, R&B, and hip-hop.

Palestinian music, explained (<https://www.palquest.org/en/highlight/10526/palestinian-music>)

Sabreen, El-Funoun, and how a modern Palestinian sound took shape.

LOOK

Look at the art.

Painters and museums that carry the place with them.

Sliman Mansour (<https://www.auktionshaus-stahl.de/en/artist/17292-sliman-mansour>)

Born 1947 in Birzeit; co-founded the League of Palestinian Artists. Lives and works in Jerusalem and Ramallah.

Malak Mattar (<https://www.bethlehemculturalfestival.com/?p=4376>)

Gaza-born painter who began at 13 and sold her first works through Instagram.

Emily Jacir and Dar Jacir (<https://www.thethirdline.com/press/73-how-artists-are-supporting-victims-of-the-israeli-palestinian/>)

Artist Emily Jacir founded the Dar Yusuf Nasri Jacir for Art and Research in Bethlehem.

Palestine Museum US (<https://www.palestinemuseum.us/>)

A museum in Woodbridge, Connecticut, showing Palestinian art.

READ

Good news, and reporting you can check.

Stories of people building something, then outlets that show their sources. Read across the spectrum.

GOOD NEWS AND ANALYSIS

Back to learning (<https://www.unicef.org/press-releases/rebuilding-hope-unicef-expands-back-learning-hundreds-thousands-children-gaza>)

UNICEF is scaling toward 336,000 children; teachers kept classes going in shelters.

Twelve groups working for peace (<https://www.positive.news/?p=453573>)

Positive News profiles joint Israeli-Palestinian groups, including Combatants for Peace and the Parents Circle.

‘Neither war nor peace’ (<https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/4/10/neither-war-nor-peace-what-gaza-looks-like-six-months-into-ceasefire>)

Al Jazeera, six months in: violence has fallen but not stopped, and reconstruction materials stay restricted.

What improved and what stalled (<https://jstreet.org/six-months-in-assessing-the-status-of-the-gaza-ceasefire/>)

J Street’s analysis: aid surged, but most of the 20-point plan has stalled.

REPORTING

OCHA occupied Palestinian territory (<https://www.ochaopt.org/>)

The UN’s humanitarian situation reports and figures.

Gisha (<https://gisha.org/en/gaza-now-facts-and-figures/>)

An Israeli rights group tracking movement and access in Gaza.

+972 Magazine (<https://www.972mag.com/>)

Independent Israeli-Palestinian journalism.

B’Tselem (<https://www.btselem.org/>)

An Israeli human-rights group documenting the occupation.

Haaretz (<https://www.haaretz.com/>)

Israeli daily. Also read **The Times of Israel** (<https://www.timesofisrael.com/>).

FOLLOW

People and pages, close to the ground.

Follow widely and check claims against a second source, including the UN and outlets on more than one side. Journalists in Gaza work in real danger, and their accounts are also contested.

JOURNALISTS AND CREATORS

Bisan Owda (https://www.instagram.com/wizard_bisan1/)

Filmmaker and journalist from Gaza. Emmy and Peabody for “It’s Bisan from Gaza and I’m Still Alive” (2024).

Motaz Azaiza (<https://www.thenationalnews.com/news/uk/2024/05/16/nakba-continues-war-photographer-motaz-azaiza-tells-london-event/>)

Photojournalist from Gaza; on TIME’s 100 most influential list.

Plestia Alaqad (<https://www.thenationalnews.com/arts-culture/books/2024/09/25/plestia-alaqad-book-gaza/>)

Journalist and poet from Gaza; her book *The Eyes of Gaza* came out in 2024.

Hind Khoudary (<https://www.newarab.com/news/gazas-voice-after-motaz-and-plestia-who-bisan-owda>)

Gaza journalist who has written for *The New Arab*, *Middle East Eye*, and +972.

LOCAL GROUPS

Palestine Red Crescent Society (<https://www.palestinercs.org/>)

Emergency medical and ambulance service.

ALLMEP (<https://www.allmep.org/>)

A coalition of 200+ Israeli and Palestinian peacebuilding organizations. Its member directory shows who works where.

Combatants for Peace (<https://cfpeace.org/>)

Former fighters from both sides working nonviolently against the occupation.

Parents Circle–Families Forum (<https://www.theparentscircle.org/en/pcf-home-page-en/>)

600+ Israeli and Palestinian families who lost someone in the conflict.

Standing Together (<https://www.standing-together.org/en>)

A grassroots movement of Jewish and Palestinian citizens of Israel.

GIVE

Give where it lands.

We list organizations, not individual crowdfunding pages, which are the hardest to check. Rising Tigers doesn't handle your money.

RELIEF

UNRWA Gaza Appeal (<https://donate.unrwa.org/int/en/gaza>)

Cash aid, food, shelter, healthcare, education. A UN agency mandated since 1949. Israel disputes its neutrality; see "What's contested" below.

Donate (<https://donate.unrwa.org/int/en/gaza>)

Anera (<https://www.anera.org/>)

Four-star on Charity Navigator and Top-Rated by CharityWatch. Works in Gaza and the West Bank and says it does not coordinate with Hamas.

Visit (<https://www.anera.org/>)

Palestine Children's Relief Fund (<https://www.pcrf.net/>)

Medical care and aid for children. On Charity Navigator's Gaza list.

Visit (<https://www.pcrf.net/>)

Middle East Children's Alliance (<https://www.mecaforpeace.org/>)

Food, water, medicine, and trauma care for children in Gaza. Four-star on Charity Navigator.

Visit (<https://www.mecaforpeace.org/>)

World Central Kitchen (<https://wck.org/donate/>)

Hot meals in crisis zones.

Donate (<https://wck.org/donate/>)

Doctors Without Borders (MSF) (<https://www.doctorswithoutborders.org/>)

Emergency medical care in Gaza.

PEACEBUILDING

Combatants for Peace (<https://cfpeace.org/>)

American Friends of Combatants for Peace is on Charity Navigator's Gaza list.

ALLMEP (<https://www.allmep.org/>)

Funds and coordinates 200+ peacebuilding groups.

Watchdog list: [Charity Navigator's Gaza page](#). Stick to registered charities: unvetted transfers can be fraud and, in some cases, a sanctions problem. Check any charity before you give: [Charity Navigator](#), [CharityWatch](#), and [Candid](#). Be wary of anyone who asks for gift cards, crypto, or a wire transfer.

BUY

Buy from the people who make it.

Buying supports makers. To fund relief, use Give.

Hirbawi keffiyeh (<https://store.arabamericanmuseum.org/products/kaffiyeh>)

Woven in Hebron since 1961 by the Hirbawi factory, described as the last one in the territories. This store gives its proceeds to the Arab American National Museum.

Handmade Palestine (<https://handmadepalestine.com/blogs/news/where-to-buy-a-palestinian-keffiyeh-online-in-the-usa>)

A social enterprise in Ramallah that works with 30+ artisan groups. Its guide explains how to spot fake keffiyehs: the pattern is woven, not printed.

Sunbula tatreez (<https://handmadepalestine.com/blogs/news/back-in-stock-your-handmade-favorites-have-returned>)

An embroidery manual and tatreez keffiyehs, fairly traded and handcrafted.

Vetted Palestinian brands (<https://www.palestine-studies.org/ar/node/1651034>)

The Institute for Palestine Studies' list of brands that hire local makers in Gaza and the West Bank. Check that each still ships.

UNDERSTAND

A short history, with the disputes marked.

Dates and figures come from the sources linked; where sources disagree, the box says so.

1917–1948

British rule (the Mandate) follows the Ottoman Empire. In 1947 the UN proposes partitioning Palestine.

1948

Israel declares independence and a war follows. About 750,000 Palestinians flee or are expelled, an event Palestinians call the Nakba. Historians debate the causes.

1967

Israel takes the West Bank, East Jerusalem, and Gaza. The occupation continues.

1993

The Oslo Accords create the Palestinian Authority.

2005–2007

Israel withdraws its settlers and troops from Gaza. Hamas takes control of the Strip in 2007, and Israel and Egypt restrict movement in and out.

7 October 2023

Hamas-led attackers kill about 1,200 people in Israel and take about 250 hostage (Israeli figures). Israel launches a war in Gaza.

Since 7 October 2023

Gaza's health ministry reports more than 73,000 people killed and more than 173,000 injured (73,246 and 173,727 as of 24 July 2026, relayed by the UN Health Cluster (<https://www.unrwa.org/resources/reports/unrwa-situation-report-231-humanitarian-crisis-gaza-strip-and-occupied-west-bank>)).

September 2025

A UN Commission of Inquiry finds that Israel has committed genocide in Gaza (<https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2025/09/israel-has-committed-genocide-gaza-strip-un-commission-finds>). Israel rejects the finding. South Africa's case at the ICJ is still open.

10 October 2025

A ceasefire begins, with a hostage exchange and a surge in aid. Violence continues at lower intensity.

2026

Reconstruction materials stay restricted, and settler violence in the West Bank is high (<https://www.ochaopt.org/content/humanitarian-situation-report-4-september-2026>).

What's contested

Casualty counts come from Gaza's health ministry, which operates under the de facto authorities. The UN relays them with that caveat; the Israeli government has questioned them.

Whether Israel's conduct is genocide: a UN Commission of Inquiry says yes, Israel rejects it, and the ICJ has not ruled; the case is still in its written phase.

Who is violating the ceasefire: Israel and Hamas accuse each other of violations.

UNRWA: Israel accuses it of being infiltrated by Hamas and has moved against its operations, including demolishing its East Jerusalem offices in January 2026. UNRWA denies tolerating or collaborating with Hamas and says it acted against staff accused of taking part in the attack ([PBS News](#)).

Aid restrictions: UN agencies say limits on "dual-use" items delay reconstruction; Israel cites security concerns.

DO

Two minutes, no money.

Small, free, specific.

Call, don't post (<https://www.usa.gov/elected-officials>)

Staffers tally calls, not reposts. Say one sentence, then hang up. Find your representatives here.

Ask about humanitarian access (<https://www.ochaopt.org/content/humanitarian-situation-report-4-september-2026>)

The UN reports funding shortfalls and access limits before winter. Ask your representatives about aid funding and access.

Read the UN Commission's findings (<https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2025/09/israel-has-committed-genocide-gaza-strip-un-commission-finds>)

The September 2025 finding. Israel rejects it.

Back the peacebuilders (<https://www.allmep.org/>)

Israeli and Palestinian groups building cooperation while the war goes on.

Read the sources (https://github.com/TahreemK13/Rising_Tigers_Initiative/blob/main/library/sources.md)

Every figure in our article as a plain-text file, with its source and the date we checked it.